

Veterans Backbone Raising Concerns Framework

Why This Exists

Some issues are bigger than complaints.

Where safety, wellbeing, safeguarding, misconduct, or serious risk may be involved, concerns must be raised through a different process.

This framework exists to protect people.

What Is A Concern?

Examples include:

- Safeguarding concerns
- Welfare concerns
- Risk of harm
- Professional misconduct
- Boundary breaches
- Abuse
- Bullying
- Harassment
- Criminal behaviour
- Serious policy breaches

Core Principles

Safety First

Protecting people always comes before protecting reputations.

Early Action

Concerns should be raised as early as possible.

Speak Up Culture

People should feel safe raising genuine concerns.

Fairness

Concerns are investigated fairly and proportionately.

Accountability

Concerns are not ignored because they are uncomfortable.

What Happens Next

Depending on the concern:

- Information may be gathered
- Safeguarding procedures may begin
- Risk assessments may be completed
- Support plans may be adjusted
- External agencies may be contacted
- Formal investigations may occur

Possible Outcomes

- No further action
- Learning actions
- Increased support
- Safeguarding measures
- Formal warnings
- Suspension
- Removal from activities
- Referral to external agencies

Why It Matters

Ignoring concerns rarely makes them disappear.

Addressing concerns early protects people, relationships, and communities.